while appealing to the United Nations, neutralizing Formosa, committing air power, and last committing nearby ground forces. Like Kennedy, Truman informed the Congressional leadership of his command decisions, which were far more generally applauded at the moment than in Kennedy's case. But Truman consciously forbore to seek Congressional action.

Given the necessity for timely choice, and the surrounding circumstances, Truman thought a declaration of war wholly inappropriate. Congressional action of that sort had last been taken in December 1941 against the Axis Powers. Nine years later it implied, both publicly and internationally, not limited hostilities, but rather total war pursued to enemy surrender. Also it implied no other termination than by peace treaty, with Senate ratification, or by resolution of the two houses of Congress. Truman was endeavoring to limit warfare, not to spread it, and to end it expeditiously. He wanted neither his constituents nor the United Nations, nor our allies, nor Moscow, nor Peking, nor—and not least—the Pentagon to view Korea in the guise of World War II. Troops were nearby in Japan. He had command authority to use them. He had four days to decide on their use. In these terms there could be no role for Congress as a partner in decision.

Truman might have made Congress a ratifier of decision. On the fifth day or the sixth he might have sought a resolution of support. In the prevailing climate there is no doubt that he could have got it. He chose not to do so, lest it blur for his successors the command authority at their disposal. Instead he pointed to the United Nations under Senate-approved treaty, justified his action by a United Nations resolution, and asked Congress for the money and controls to prosecute the war. Congress complied. As the fighting dragged on after Chinese intervention, however, Truman paid a heavy political price for failing to make Congress share his June decision. This became "Truman's war." To it can be attributed the defeat of Truman's party in the 1952 elections and the Presidency of Dwight D. Eisenhower.

Conscious of this cost to Truman, the Eisenhower Administration devised a protective means of *pre*-associating Congress with command decision, the "Quemoy-Matsu" formula, which Speaker of the House Sam Rayburn characterized at the time as a "blank check." This was a Congressional resolution covering a given geographic area, which authorized the President to do no more than he had constitutional authority to do: employ armed force if circumstances should warrant. As pioneered by Eisenhower, this formula required first such tension in the